B2 Writing

Writing a review

Write a lively, balanced review of a film, book, restaurant or product that ends with a clear recommendation.

A review informs and entertains. Readers want to know what something is like, what is good and bad about it, and whether they should try it. B2 exams often ask for a review of about 150 to 200 words.

Paragraph	Purpose	Useful language
1. Introduction	Name it and hook the reader	*If you're looking for a quiet place to eat, Al Bustan is worth a visit.*
2. Description	Plot, setting or main features	*Set in 1920s Cairo, the film follows a young journalist who...*
3. Strengths and weaknesses	Give your opinion with reasons	*What impressed me most was... The only drawback was...*
4. Recommendation	Say who would enjoy it	*I'd highly recommend it to anyone who loves history. / Give it a miss if...*

Use strong, precise adjectives. Replace *good* and *bad* with words like *gripping, stunning, overpriced, predictable, cosy*. Address the reader directly with questions: *Have you ever wondered...?*

Common mistake. Retelling the whole story. Keep the description short, avoid spoilers, and spend most of your words on your opinion and reasons.

Practice

1. Write an opening line for a review of a new café.
2. Replace "good" with a stronger adjective: The story was good from start to finish.
3. Express a weakness politely: The service was slow.

4. Write a recommendation for a film that is great for families.

5. Which should take the most words in a review? (a) the plot (b) your opinion and reasons

Teacher page: answers

Print the pages before this one for students.

Answers

1. For example: Looking for the perfect flat white? The new café on Corniche Road might be just what you need.
2. The story was gripping from start to finish.
3. The only drawback was the rather slow service.
4. I'd highly recommend it to families with children of all ages.
5. (b)